

Signals & Systems

Assignments 3 & 4 — Complete Worked Solutions

Fourier Series • Fourier Transform

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How to use this document. Every problem is solved from first principles with the intermediate steps shown, and each answer that has a spectrum is accompanied by a magnitude/phase plot. A handful of problems specify the signal only through a sketch in the original PDF; for those, the waveform actually used is stated explicitly in an orange box. If your printed figure differs, the *method* is identical—only the numbers in the final formula change, and the box tells you exactly which assumption to revisit.

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Conventions used throughout

For a periodic signal of period T_0 and fundamental frequency $\omega_0 = 2\pi/T_0$:

$$\text{Exponential FS: } x(t) = \sum_{n=-\infty}^{\infty} D_n e^{jn\omega_0 t}, \quad D_n = \frac{1}{T_0} \int_{T_0} x(t) e^{-jn\omega_0 t} dt.$$

$$\text{Compact trigonometric FS: } x(t) = C_0 + \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} C_n \cos(n\omega_0 t + \theta_n).$$

The two are linked by

$$C_0 = D_0, \quad C_n = 2|D_n| \ (n \geq 1), \quad \theta_n = \angle D_n, \quad D_{-n} = D_n^* \ (\text{real signals}).$$

For the Fourier transform we use the (Lathi) convention

$$X(\omega) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(t) e^{-j\omega t} dt, \quad x(t) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} X(\omega) e^{j\omega t} d\omega,$$

with $\text{sinc}(x) = \frac{\sin x}{x}$ and the key pair $\text{sinc}(at) \xleftrightarrow{\mathcal{F}} \frac{\pi}{a} \text{rect}\left(\frac{\omega}{2a}\right)$ (a gate of height π/a for $|\omega| < a$).

1 Assignment 3 — Fourier Series

1.1 Q1 — Full-wave rectified cosine

The signal is $x(t) = A|\cos \pi t|$. Because $\cos \pi t$ has period 2, taking the absolute value halves it, so

$$T_0 = 1, \quad \omega_0 = \frac{2\pi}{T_0} = 2\pi.$$

$x(t)$ is **even**, hence $b_n = 0$ and only cosine terms survive. On the interval $(-\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{2})$ the cosine is non-negative, so $|\cos \pi t| = \cos \pi t$ there.

DC term.

$$C_0 = a_0 = \frac{1}{T_0} \int_{-1/2}^{1/2} A \cos \pi t dt = A \left[\frac{\sin \pi t}{\pi} \right]_{-1/2}^{1/2} = \frac{A}{\pi} (1 - (-1)) = \boxed{\frac{2A}{\pi}}.$$

Harmonics. Using $\cos \pi t \cos 2\pi n t = \frac{1}{2} [\cos(2n+1)\pi t + \cos(2n-1)\pi t]$,

$$a_n = 2A \int_{-1/2}^{1/2} \cos \pi t \cos 2\pi n t dt = A \left[\frac{\sin(2n+1)\pi t}{(2n+1)\pi} + \frac{\sin(2n-1)\pi t}{(2n-1)\pi} \right]_{-1/2}^{1/2} = \frac{4A(-1)^{n+1}}{\pi(4n^2-1)}.$$

The magnitude is $\frac{4A}{\pi(4n^2-1)}$ (positive, since $4n^2-1 > 0$); the sign $(-1)^{n+1}$ supplies the phase: $\theta_n = 0$ for odd n and $\theta_n = \pi$ for even n .

Result

$$x(t) = \frac{2A}{\pi} + \frac{4A}{\pi} \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^{n+1}}{4n^2-1} \cos(2\pi n t), \quad C_1 = \frac{4A}{3\pi} \approx 0.424A, \quad C_2 = \frac{4A}{15\pi}, \quad C_3 = \frac{4A}{35\pi}.$$

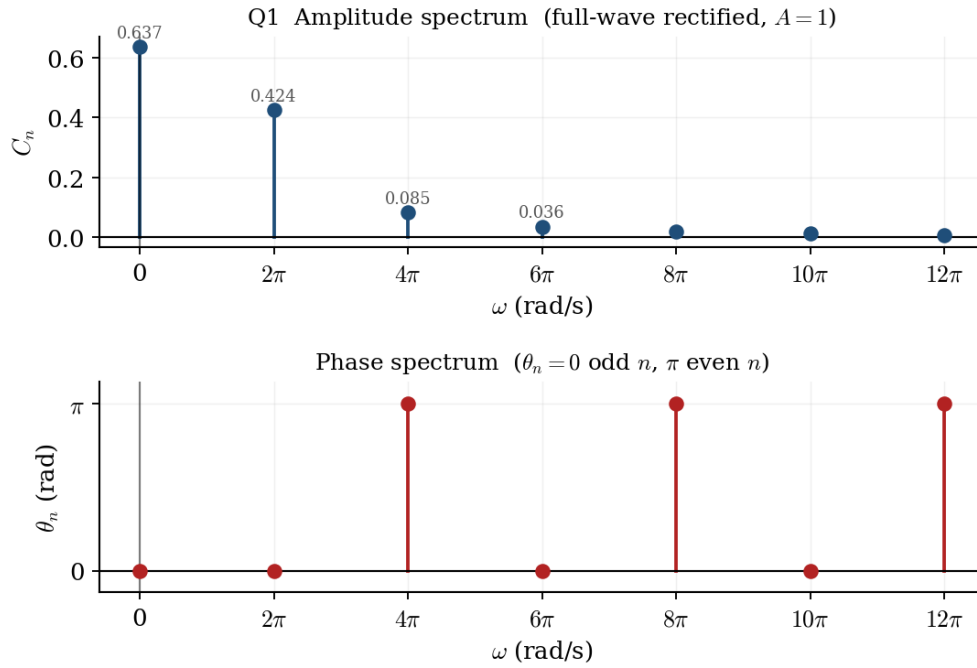


Figure 1: Q1: amplitude and phase spectra of the full-wave rectified cosine ($A = 1$). Lines fall off as $1/(4n^2 - 1)$; the phase alternates $0, \pi$.

1.2 Q2 — Triangular wave

The triangle peaks at A at $t = nT_0$ and crosses zero at $t = (n + \frac{1}{2})T_0$, so on one period $x(t) = A(1 - \frac{2|t|}{T_0})$ for $|t| \leq T_0/2$. It is **even**, so $b_n = 0$.

$$C_0 = a_0 = \frac{2}{T_0} \int_0^{T_0/2} A \left(1 - \frac{2t}{T_0}\right) dt = \frac{2A}{T_0} \left[t - \frac{t^2}{T_0}\right]_0^{T_0/2} = \frac{2A}{T_0} \cdot \frac{T_0}{4} = \boxed{\frac{A}{2}}.$$

Integrating $a_n = \frac{4A}{T_0} \int_0^{T_0/2} \left(1 - \frac{2t}{T_0}\right) \cos(n\omega_0 t) dt$ by parts gives the standard triangular result

$$a_n = \frac{2A(1 - (-1)^n)}{\pi^2 n^2} = \begin{cases} \frac{4A}{\pi^2 n^2}, & n \text{ odd}, \\ 0, & n \text{ even}, \end{cases} \quad \theta_n = 0.$$

Result

$$x(t) = \frac{A}{2} + \frac{4A}{\pi^2} \left[\cos \omega_0 t + \frac{1}{9} \cos 3\omega_0 t + \frac{1}{25} \cos 5\omega_0 t + \cdots \right], \quad \omega_0 = \frac{2\pi}{T_0}.$$

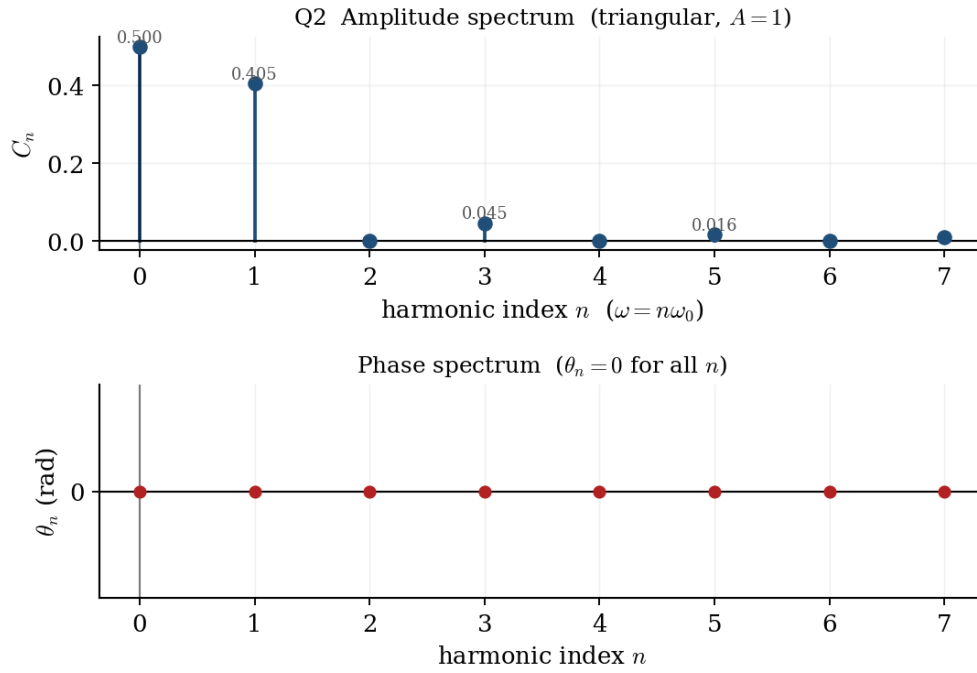


Figure 2: Q2: only odd harmonics are present, decaying as $1/n^2$; all phases are zero.

1.3 Q3 — Exponential FS of an odd square wave

Reading of the figure

The sketch is read as an **odd square pulse** of period $T_0 = 3$ ($\omega_0 = \frac{2\pi}{3}$): one period equals +1 on $(-1, 0)$, -1 on $(0, 1)$, and 0 on the remaining strips. If your figure has different levels/widths, only the constants below scale.

$$D_0 = \frac{1}{3} \left[\int_{-1}^0 (+1) dt + \int_0^1 (-1) dt \right] = 0.$$

For $n \neq 0$,

$$D_n = \frac{1}{3} \left[\int_{-1}^0 e^{-jn\omega_0 t} dt - \int_0^1 e^{-jn\omega_0 t} dt \right] = \frac{1}{3} \cdot \frac{2 - e^{jn\omega_0} - e^{-jn\omega_0}}{-jn\omega_0} = \frac{2(1 - \cos \frac{2\pi n}{3})}{-j2\pi n} = j \frac{1 - \cos \frac{2\pi n}{3}}{\pi n}.$$

Since $\cos \frac{2\pi n}{3} = 1$ when $3 \mid n$ (giving $D_n = 0$) and $= -\frac{1}{2}$ otherwise,

Result

$$D_n = \begin{cases} \frac{3j}{2\pi n}, & 3 \nmid n, \\ 0, & 3 \mid n, \end{cases} \quad |D_n| = \frac{3}{2\pi|n|}, \quad \angle D_n = \begin{cases} +\pi/2, & n > 0, \\ -\pi/2, & n < 0. \end{cases}$$

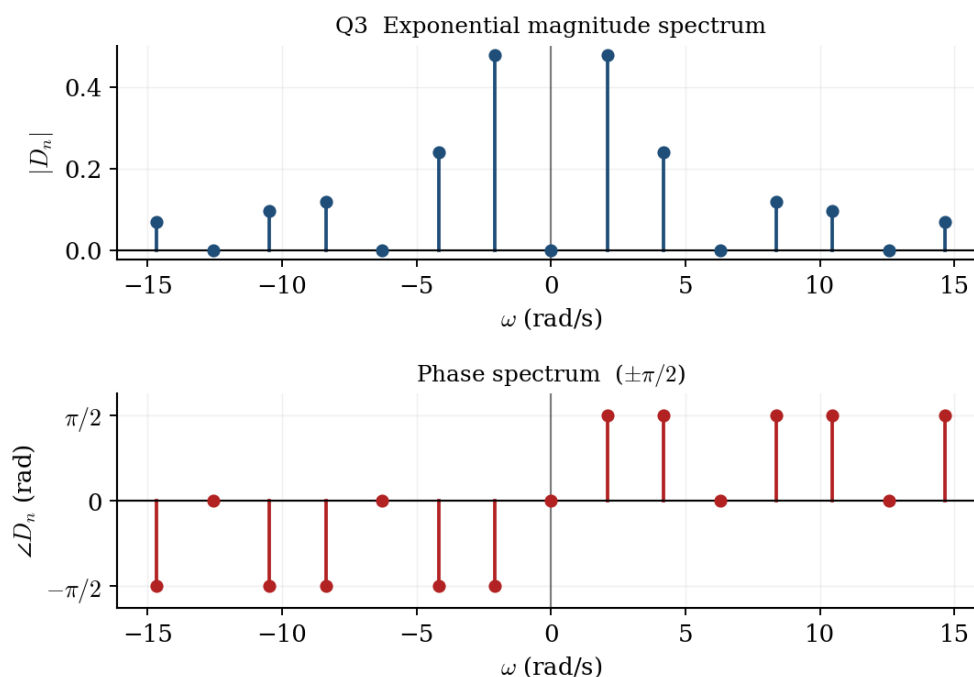


Figure 3: Q3: purely imaginary coefficients — magnitude $\propto 1/|n|$ with every third line missing, phase $\pm\pi/2$.

1.4 Q4 — Exponential FS of a sawtooth

Reading of the figure

The ramp is read as $x(t) = \frac{2}{3}t$ on $[0, 3]$, repeated with period $T_0 = 3$ ($\omega_0 = \frac{2\pi}{3}$).

$$D_0 = \frac{1}{3} \int_0^3 \frac{2}{3}t \, dt = 1.$$

With $a = -jn\omega_0$ and $\int t e^{at} \, dt = \frac{e^{at}}{a^2}(at - 1)$, and noting $\omega_0 \cdot 3 = 2\pi \Rightarrow e^{a \cdot 3} = e^{-j2\pi n} = 1$,

$$D_n = \frac{2}{9} \int_0^3 t e^{-jn\omega_0 t} \, dt = \frac{2}{9} \cdot \frac{-j2\pi n}{(-jn\omega_0)^2} = \frac{2}{9} \cdot \frac{9j}{2\pi n} = \frac{j}{\pi n}.$$

Result

$$D_0 = 1, \quad D_n = \frac{j}{\pi n} \quad (n \neq 0), \quad |D_n| = \frac{1}{\pi|n|}, \quad \angle D_n = \pm\frac{\pi}{2}.$$

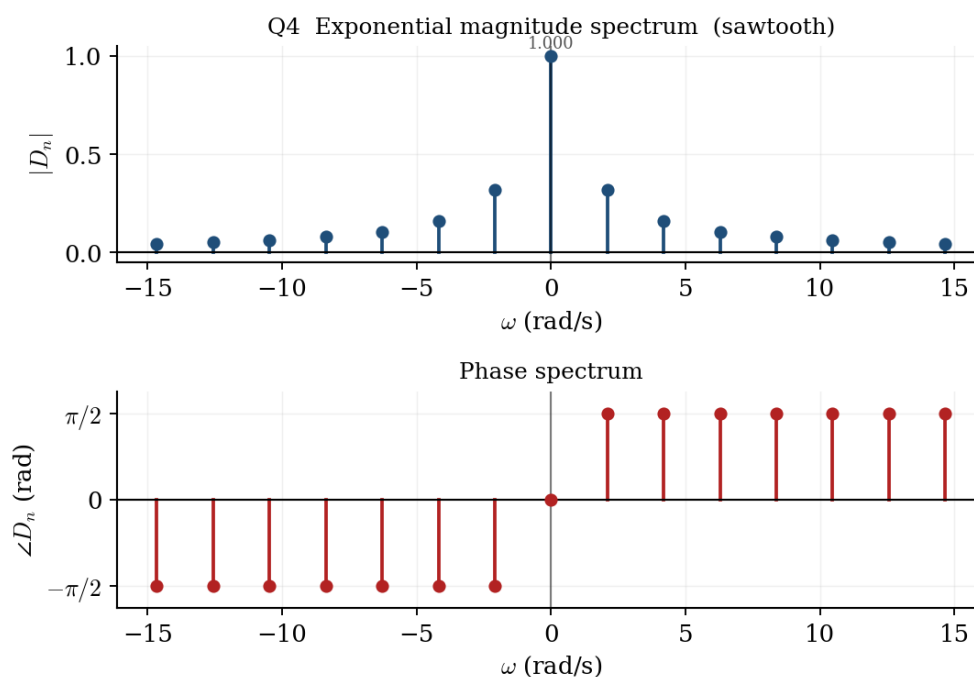


Figure 4: Q4: sawtooth spectrum — a DC value of 1, magnitudes $\propto 1/|n|$, phase $\pm\pi/2$.

1.5 Q5 — Compact-trig FS of an impulse train

Here $x(t) = 2\pi \sum_k \delta(t - 2k)$, so $T_0 = 2$ and $\omega_0 = \pi$. Over the one period $(-1, 1)$ only $\delta(t)$ lies inside, hence

$$D_n = \frac{1}{2} \int_{-1}^1 2\pi \delta(t) e^{-jn\pi t} dt = \pi \quad \text{for every } n.$$

A flat exponential spectrum gives $C_0 = \pi$ and $C_n = 2|D_n| = 2\pi$, with $\theta_n = 0$.

Result

$$x(t) = \pi + 2\pi [\cos \pi t + \cos 2\pi t + \cos 3\pi t + \cdots].$$

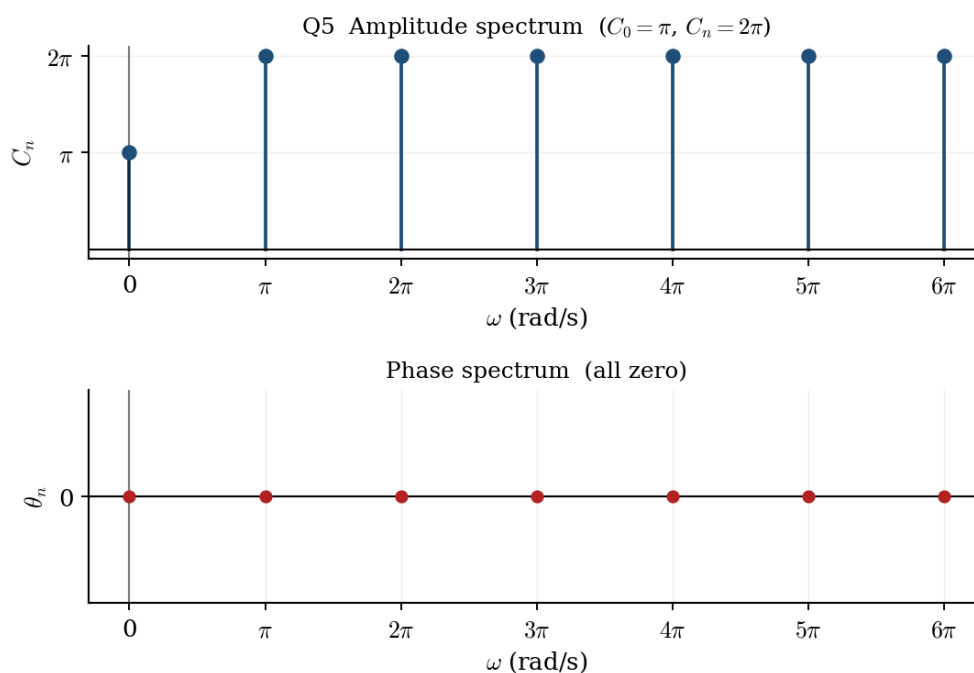


Figure 5: Q5: an impulse train has a flat spectrum — $C_0 = \pi, C_n = 2\pi$, all phases zero.

1.6 Q6 — Exponential FS of a weighted impulse train

Reading of the figure

Impulses sit at every integer with weight $+1$ at odd integers and -2 at even integers; period $T_0 = 2, \omega_0 = \pi$. Inside one period only $t = 0$ (weight -2) and $t = 1$ (weight $+1$) occur.

$$D_n = \frac{1}{2} [(-2)e^0 + (1)e^{-jn\pi}] = \frac{-2 + (-1)^n}{2} = \begin{cases} -\frac{1}{2}, & n \text{ even,} \\ -\frac{3}{2}, & n \text{ odd.} \end{cases}$$

All coefficients are negative real numbers, so every phase equals π .

Result

$$D_0 = -\frac{1}{2}, \quad |D_n| = \begin{cases} \frac{1}{2}, & n \text{ even} \\ \frac{3}{2}, & n \text{ odd} \end{cases}, \quad \angle D_n = \pi \text{ for all } n.$$

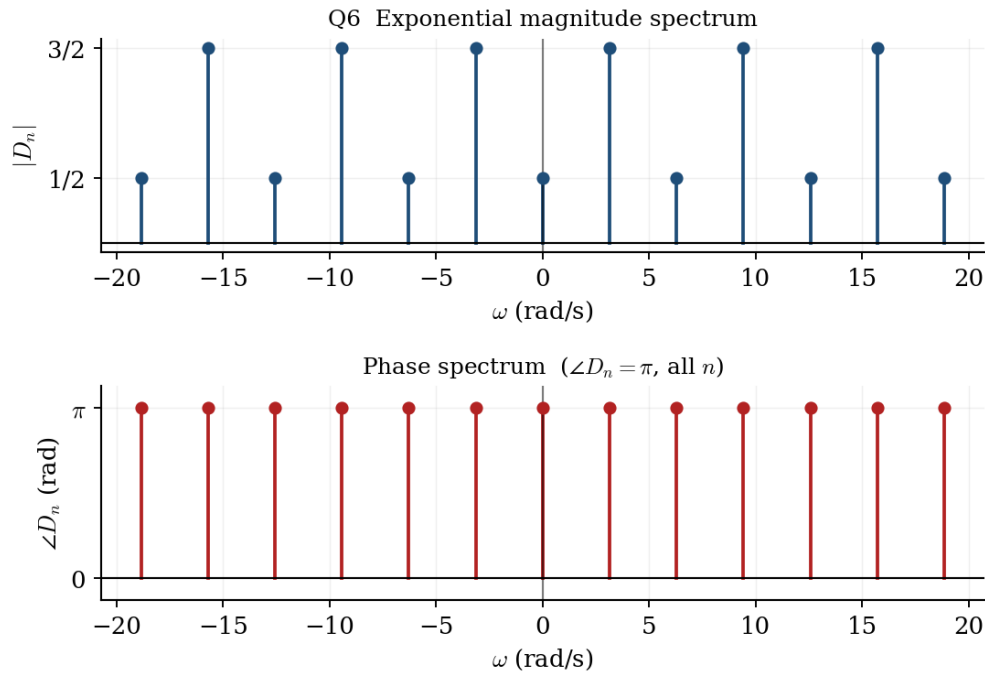


Figure 6: Q6: even/odd harmonics take magnitudes $\frac{1}{2}$ and $\frac{3}{2}$; the constant negative sign shows as a uniform phase of π .

1.7 Q7 — Periodicity and harmonics

A sum of sinusoids is periodic *iff* every pairwise ratio of frequencies is rational; the fundamental ω_0 is then the largest number of which all frequencies are integer multiples.

- (a) $2 \sin 3t + 7 \cos \pi t$: ratio $3/\pi$ is **irrational** $\Rightarrow$ **aperiodic**.
- (b) $7 \cos \pi t + 5 \sin 2\pi t$: frequencies $\pi, 2\pi$; $\omega_0 = \pi$, $T_0 = 2$. **Periodic**; these are the 1st and 2nd harmonics.
- (c) $3 \cos \sqrt{2}t + 5 \cos 2t$: ratio $\sqrt{2}/2$ is **irrational** $\Rightarrow$ **aperiodic**.
- (d) $\sin \frac{5t}{2} + 3 \cos 3t + 3 \sin(\frac{t}{7} + 30^\circ)$: frequencies $\frac{5}{2}, 3, \frac{1}{7}$. The largest common divisor is $\omega_0 = \frac{1}{14}$, so $T_0 = 28\pi$. **Periodic**; the terms are the 35th ($\frac{5}{2}$), 42nd (3) and 2nd ($\frac{1}{7}$) harmonics.

1.8 Q8 — Compact-trig and exponential FS of a given signal

$$f(t) = 3 + \sqrt{3} \cos 2t + \sin 2t + \sin(5t - \frac{\pi}{6}) - \frac{1}{2} \cos(7t + \frac{\pi}{3}), \quad \omega_0 = 1.$$

(a) Compact trigonometric form. Combine the two $\omega = 2$ terms and convert each sine to a cosine:

$$\sqrt{3} \cos 2t + \sin 2t = 2 \cos(2t - 30^\circ), \quad \sin(5t - \frac{\pi}{6}) = \cos(5t - \frac{2\pi}{3}), \quad -\frac{1}{2} \cos(7t + \frac{\pi}{3}) = \frac{1}{2} \cos(7t - \frac{2\pi}{3}).$$

Result

$$f(t) = 3 + 2 \cos(2t - 30^\circ) + \cos(5t - 120^\circ) + \frac{1}{2} \cos(7t - 120^\circ).$$

$$C_0 = 3, \quad C_2 = 2 (\theta = -30^\circ), \quad C_5 = 1 (\theta = -120^\circ), \quad C_7 = \frac{1}{2} (\theta = -120^\circ).$$

(b) Exponential form. Using $C_n = 2|D_n|$ and $\angle D_{\pm n} = \mp \theta_n$:

$$D_0 = 3, \quad |D_{\pm 2}| = 1 (\angle = \mp 30^\circ), \quad |D_{\pm 5}| = \frac{1}{2} (\angle = \mp 120^\circ), \quad |D_{\pm 7}| = \frac{1}{4} (\angle = \mp 120^\circ).$$

(c, d) Equivalence. Each conjugate pair recombines as $D_n e^{jnt} + D_{-n} e^{-jnt} = 2|D_n| \cos(nt + \angle D_n) = C_n \cos(nt + \theta_n)$, which reproduces the compact-trig terms above and hence the original $f(t)$.

Q8 spectra of $f(t) = 3 + \sqrt{3} \cos 2t + \sin 2t + \sin(5t - \pi/6) - \frac{1}{2} \cos(7t + \pi/3)$

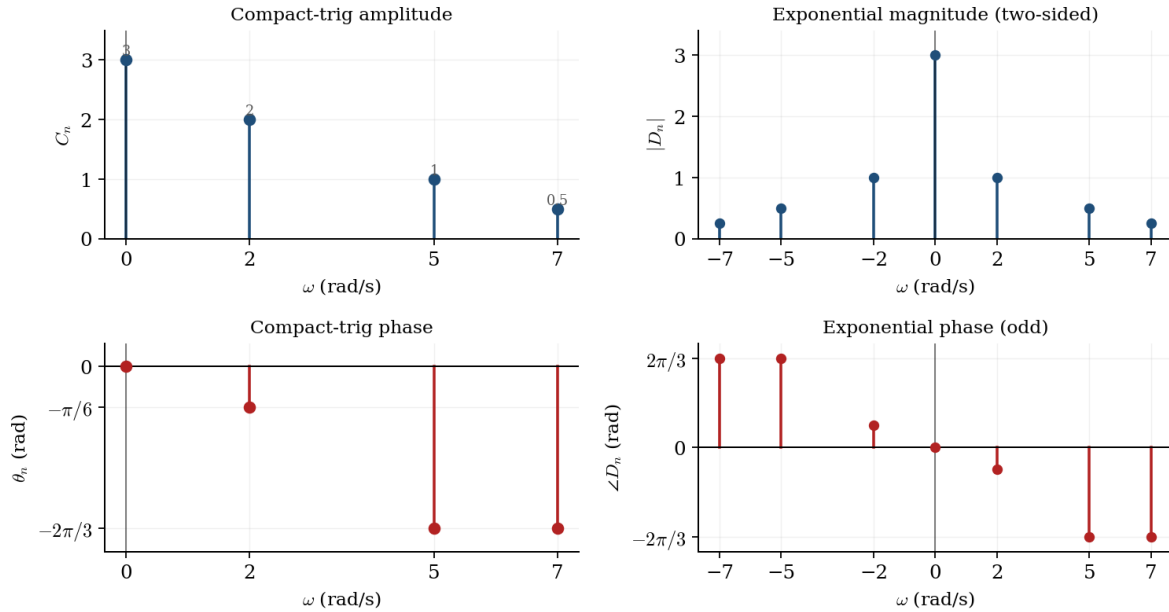


Figure 7: Q8: compact-trig (one-sided, left) and exponential (two-sided, right) spectra. The exponential phase is the odd reflection of the trig phase.

1.9 Q9 — A signal given in exponential form

$$x(t) = (2 + j2)e^{-j3t} + j2e^{-jt} + 3 - j2e^{jt} + (2 - j2)e^{j3t}, \quad \omega_0 = 1.$$

Matching to $\sum_n D_n e^{jnt}$ reads the coefficients directly:

$$D_0 = 3, \quad D_1 = -j2, \quad D_{-1} = j2, \quad D_3 = 2 - j2, \quad D_{-3} = 2 + j2.$$

Since $D_{-1} = D_1^*$ and $D_{-3} = D_3^*$, the signal is **real**. Hence

$$|D_1| = 2 (\angle -90^\circ), \quad |D_{-1}| = 2 (\angle +90^\circ), \quad |D_3| = 2\sqrt{2} (\angle -45^\circ), \quad |D_{-3}| = 2\sqrt{2} (\angle +45^\circ).$$

Compact trig. $C_0 = 3$, $C_1 = 2|D_1| = 4$ ($\theta_1 = -90^\circ$), $C_3 = 2|D_3| = 4\sqrt{2}$ ($\theta_3 = -45^\circ$):

Result

$$x(t) = 3 + 4 \cos(t - 90^\circ) + 4\sqrt{2} \cos(3t - 45^\circ) = 3 + 4 \sin t + 4 \cos 3t + 4 \sin 3t.$$

(d) Bandwidth $= \omega_{\max} - \omega_{\min} = 3 - 1 = 2$ rad/s (highest harmonic present is 3 rad/s).

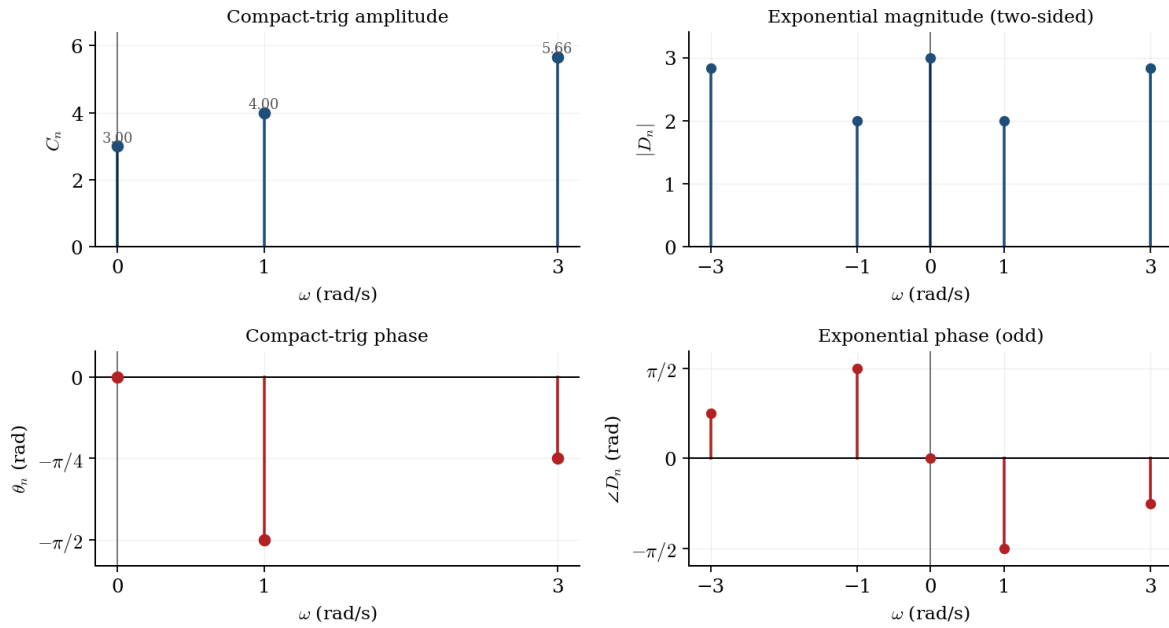
Q9 spectra of the real periodic signal $x(t)$


Figure 8: Q9: two-sided exponential spectrum (right) and the equivalent one-sided compact-trig spectrum (left).

1.10 Q10 — From a given exponential spectrum to the signal

Reading of the figure

The plotted lines are read as $|D_0| = 2$, $|D_{\pm 1}| = 1.5$, $|D_{\pm 2}| = 1$, $|D_{\pm 3}| = 0.5$ (a triangular envelope reaching zero at $n = \pm 4$), with phase $\angle D_n = -n\pi/3$ and $\omega_0 = 1$ rad/s.

(a) **Exponential synthesis.** The $n = \pm 3$ terms carry phase $\mp\pi$, i.e. $e^{\mp j\pi} = -1$:

$$x(t) = 2 + 1.5 e^{-j\pi/3} e^{jt} + 1.5 e^{j\pi/3} e^{-jt} + e^{-j2\pi/3} e^{j2t} + e^{j2\pi/3} e^{-j2t} - 0.5 e^{j3t} - 0.5 e^{-j3t}.$$

(b) **Compact trig.** $C_0 = 2$, $C_n = 2|D_n|$, $\theta_n = \angle D_n$:

$$C_1 = 3 \ (\theta = -60^\circ), \quad C_2 = 2 \ (\theta = -120^\circ), \quad C_3 = 1 \ (\theta = -180^\circ).$$

Result

$$x(t) = 2 + 3 \cos(t - 60^\circ) + 2 \cos(2t - 120^\circ) - \cos 3t.$$

(c, d) Pairing $D_n e^{jnt} + D_{-n} e^{-jnt} = C_n \cos(nt + \theta_n)$ confirms the two representations are identical.

Q10 given exponential spectra (left) $\Rightarrow$ derived compact-trig spectra (right)

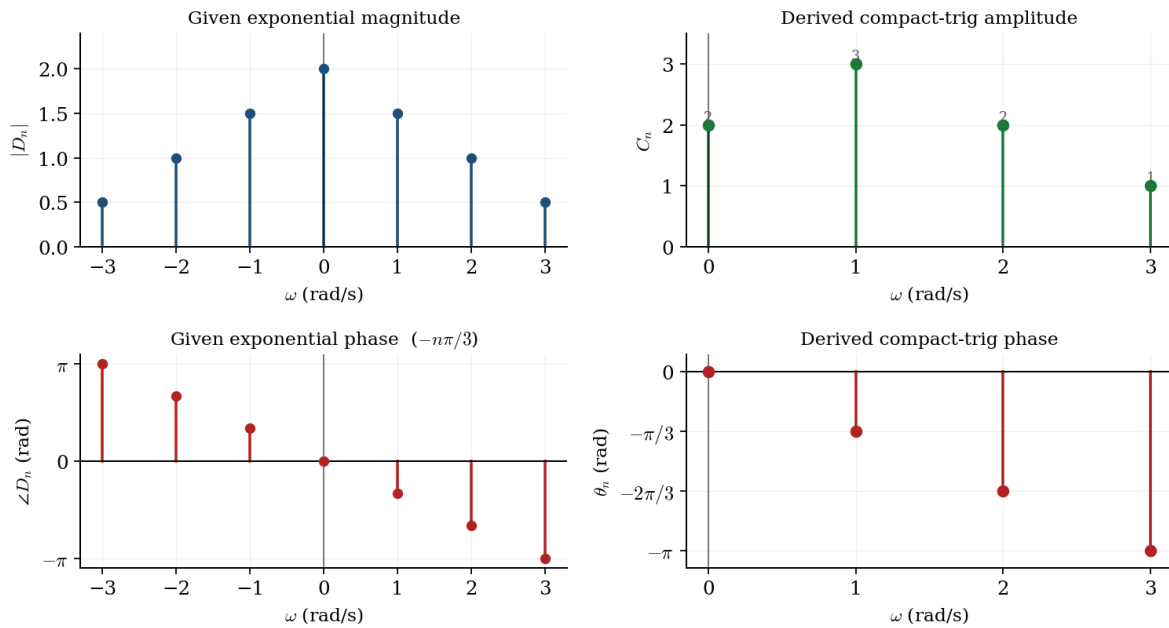


Figure 9: Q10: the given exponential spectra (blue/red, left) and the derived compact-trig spectra (green/red, right).

2 Assignment 4 — Fourier Transform

2.1 Q1 — Convolution $y = x_1 * x_2$

$$x_1(t) = \text{sinc}(4\pi t), \quad x_2(t) = \cos 2\pi t.$$

(a) With $a = 4\pi$ in the sinc pair,

$$X_1(\omega) = \frac{\pi}{4\pi} \text{rect}\left(\frac{\omega}{8\pi}\right) = \frac{1}{4} \quad \text{for } |\omega| < 4\pi,$$

a gate of height $\frac{1}{4}$. (The time signal has zeros at $t = k/4$ and unit peak.)

(b) $X_2(\omega) = \pi[\delta(\omega - 2\pi) + \delta(\omega + 2\pi)]$.

(c) Convolution in time $\Rightarrow$ multiplication in frequency. Because $|\pm 2\pi| < 4\pi$, the gate equals $\frac{1}{4}$ at both impulses:

$$Y(\omega) = X_1(\omega)X_2(\omega) = \frac{\pi}{4}[\delta(\omega - 2\pi) + \delta(\omega + 2\pi)] \Rightarrow \boxed{y(t) = \frac{1}{4} \cos 2\pi t}.$$

Intuitively, convolving with a sinc is ideal low-pass filtering; the 2π tone sits in the passband and is merely scaled by $\frac{1}{4}$.

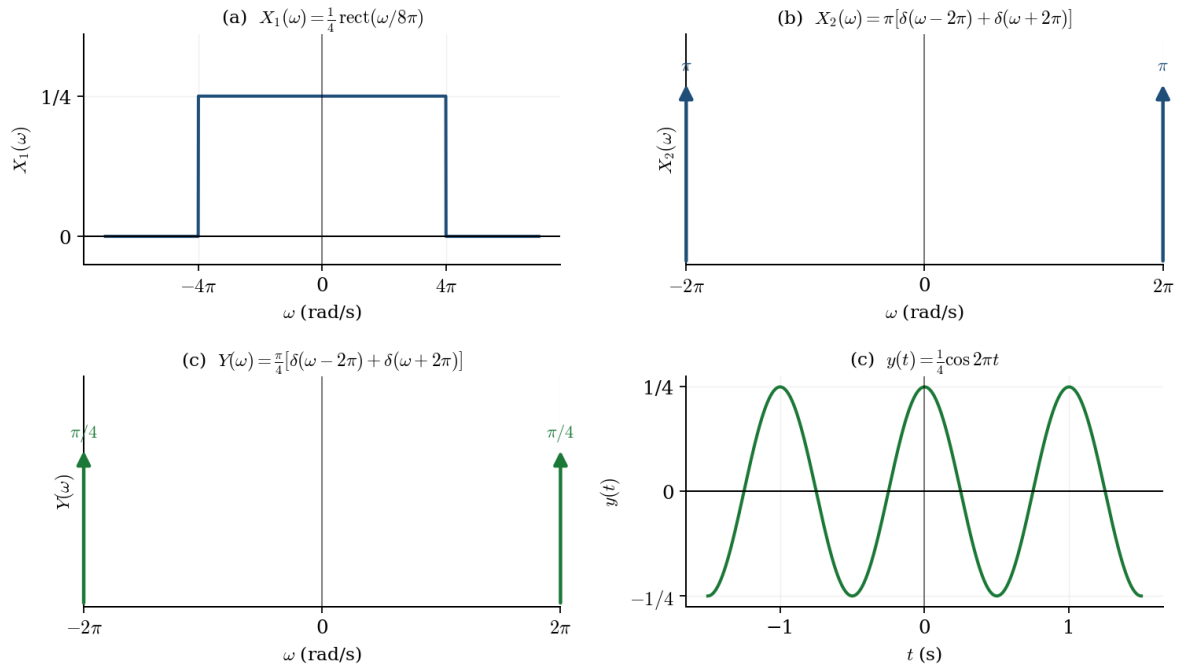


Figure 10: Q1: the sinc gate X_1 , the cosine's impulses X_2 , their product Y , and the resulting time signal $y(t) = \frac{1}{4} \cos 2\pi t$.

2.2 Q2 — Property-based transforms of a triangular spectrum

The given spectrum is the real triangle $X(\omega) = 1 - \frac{2|\omega|}{\pi}$ for $|\omega| \leq \frac{\pi}{2}$ (zero phase).

- (i) **Time scaling** $x(3t) \xleftrightarrow{\mathcal{F}} \frac{1}{3}X(\omega/3)$: peak shrinks to $\frac{1}{3}$, base widens to $\pm \frac{3\pi}{2}$; phase still 0.
- (ii) **Time shift** $x(t - 5) \xleftrightarrow{\mathcal{F}} e^{-j5\omega}X(\omega)$: magnitude unchanged; a *linear* phase -5ω is added.
- (iii) **Modulation** $x(t) \cos 2\pi t \xleftrightarrow{\mathcal{F}} \frac{1}{2}[X(\omega - 2\pi) + X(\omega + 2\pi)]$: two half-height triangles centred at $\pm 2\pi$.
- (iv) **Convolution** $x(t) * \text{sinc}(\frac{\pi t}{4})$. Since $\text{sinc}(\frac{\pi t}{4}) \xleftrightarrow{\mathcal{F}} 4 \text{rect}(\frac{\omega}{\pi/2})$ (height 4 for $|\omega| < \frac{\pi}{4}$), the result is $4X(\omega)$ restricted to $|\omega| < \frac{\pi}{4}$: value 4 at $\omega = 0$, falling linearly to 2 at $\pm \frac{\pi}{4}$, then 0.

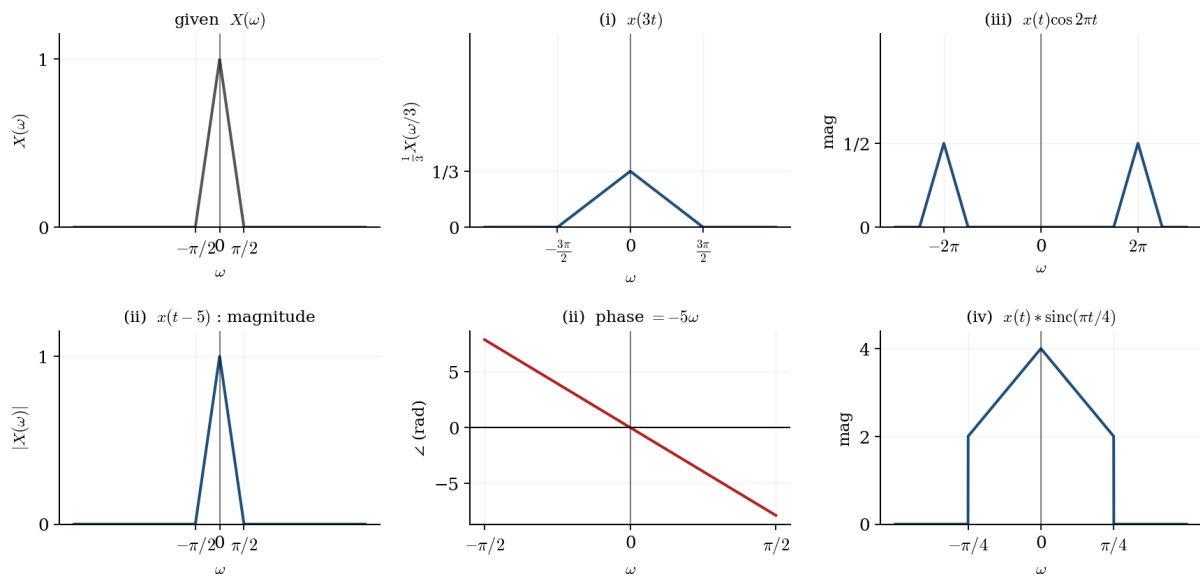
Q2 effect of each operation on the triangular spectrum $X(\omega)$


Figure 11: Q2: each Fourier property reshapes the base triangle $X(\omega)$ — scaling, a linear-phase shift, modulation to $\pm 2\pi$, and band-limiting by convolution.

2.3 Q3 — Recovering $x(t)$ by frequency shifting

$X(\omega)$ consists of two unit gates on $[3, 5]$ and $[-5, -3]$. Write them as a baseband gate $G(\omega) = \text{rect}(\frac{\omega}{2})$ (i.e. 1 for $|\omega| < 1$) shifted by ± 4 :

$$X(\omega) = G(\omega - 4) + G(\omega + 4).$$

The baseband gate inverts to $g(t) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_{-1}^1 e^{j\omega t} d\omega = \frac{\sin t}{\pi t} = \frac{1}{\pi} \text{sinc}(t)$. Frequency shifting ($G(\omega \mp 4) \xleftrightarrow{\mathcal{F}} g(t)e^{\pm j4t}$) then gives

Result

$$x(t) = g(t)(e^{j4t} + e^{-j4t}) = \frac{2}{\pi} \text{sinc}(t) \cos 4t = \frac{2 \sin t}{\pi t} \cos 4t.$$

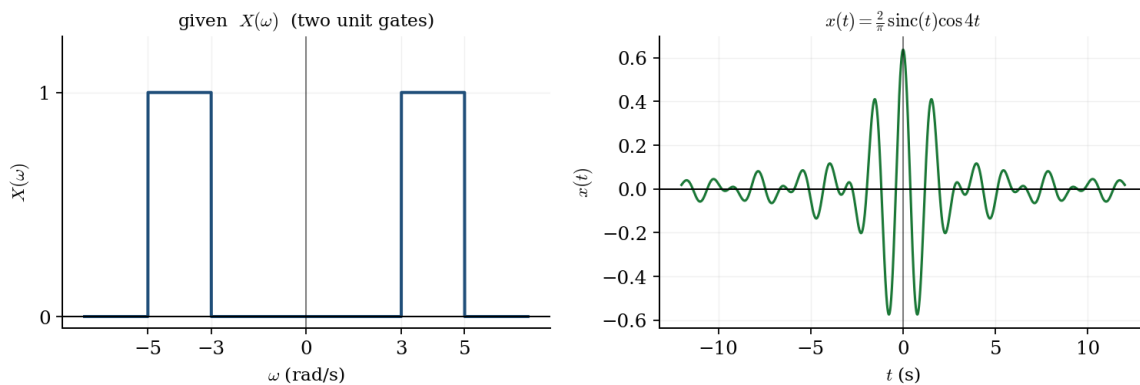


Figure 12: Q3: the two-gate spectrum (left) and the reconstructed signal — a sinc envelope modulated by $\cos 4t$ (right).

2.4 Q4 — Inverse transform by the convolution property

$$X(\omega) = \frac{1}{(a + j\omega)^2} = \left[\frac{1}{a + j\omega} \right]^2.$$

Because $\frac{1}{a + j\omega} \xleftrightarrow{\mathcal{F}} e^{-at}u(t)$, a product in frequency is a convolution in time, so $x(t)$ is $e^{-at}u(t)$ convolved with itself:

$$x(t) = \int_0^t e^{-a\tau} e^{-a(t-\tau)} d\tau = e^{-at} \int_0^t d\tau = t e^{-at}, \quad t \geq 0.$$

Result

$$x(t) = t e^{-at} u(t).$$

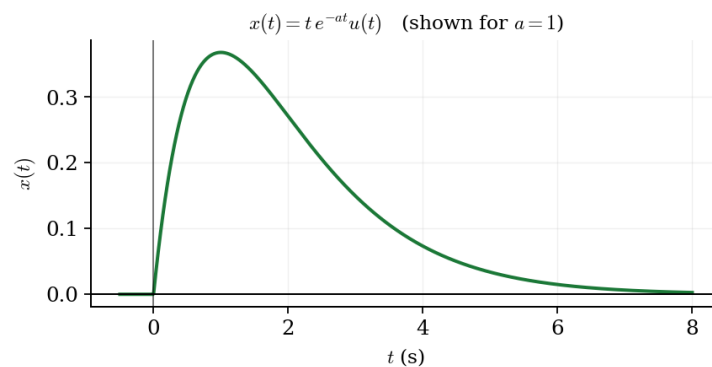


Figure 13: Q4: the self-convolution of a decaying exponential rises linearly then decays — the classic $t e^{-at}u(t)$ shape.

2.5 Q5 — A truncated exponential and three constructions

The base signal is $x(t) = e^{-2t}$ for $0 \leq t \leq 1$ (zero elsewhere), with

$$X(\omega) = \int_0^1 e^{-(2+j\omega)t} dt = \frac{1 - e^{-2}e^{-j\omega}}{2 + j\omega}.$$

Reading of the figure

The three companion sketches are read as the even extension, the odd extension, and a time-expansion of the same pulse. Each is handled by one Fourier property, so any alternative reading simply selects a different property from the same list.

- $x_1(t) = x(t) + x(-t)$ (**even**): $X_1(\omega) = X(\omega) + X(-\omega) = 2 \operatorname{Re}\{X(\omega)\}$.
- $x_2(t) = x(t) - x(-t)$ (**odd**): $X_2(\omega) = X(\omega) - X(-\omega) = 2j \operatorname{Im}\{X(\omega)\}$.
- $x_3(t) = x(t/2)$ (**time-expanded**): $X_3(\omega) = 2 X(2\omega)$.

The even part is purely real, the odd part purely imaginary, and the stretched pulse has a correspondingly compressed, twice-as-tall spectrum.

Q5 base pulse and its even / odd / time-scaled constructions

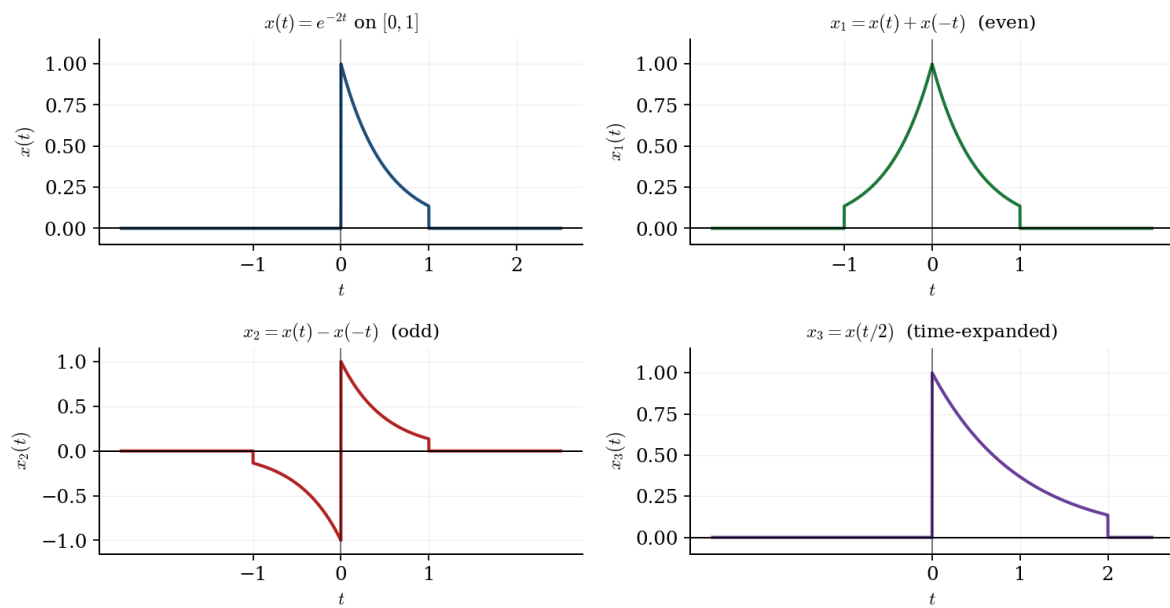


Figure 14: Q5: the base pulse and its even, odd, and time-expanded ($t \rightarrow t/2$) constructions in the time domain.